35. Line XIV, Erragudi Edict V, ibid.: 24.

36. Lines III–IV, Erragudi edict IX, ibid.: 40.

37. Line VIII, ibid.

38. See Rich (2008): 166.

39. Sircar has translated the word ‘samavaya’ as ‘restrained speech’ whereas it is generally understood as ‘concord’. See Hultzsch (1925): 21, and Pandeya (1965): 16, for the later interpretation.

40. Line XIV, Erragudi Edict XIII. Sircar (1979): 85.

41. *AS* 8.4.43. Kangle (1972): pt. II, 400.

42. Lines XVIII–XIX, Erragudi Edict XIII. Sircar (1979): 85.

43. While the impact of such measures in the various independent kingdoms must have depended on a variety of issues, scholars like Rhys Davids read this part of the rock edict with an element of disbelief, bordering on disdain: ‘It is difficult to say how much of this is mere royal rhodomontade. It is quite likely that the Greek kings are only thrown in by way of make-weight, as it were; and that no emissaries had been actually sent there at all. Even had they been sent, there is little reason to believe that the Greek self-complacency would have been much disturbed. Asoka’s estimate of the results obtained is better evidence of his own vanity than it is of Greek docility. We may imagine the Greek amusement at the absurd idea of a “barbarian” teaching them their duty; but we can scarcely imagine them discarding their gods and their superstitions at the bidding of an alien king.’ See Rhys Davids (1903): 298–9. Possibly, this disdain may have been partly a consequence of Rhys Davids being a colonial civil servant: he served as one in Sri Lanka.

44. A strong political connotation of the term ‘dharmavijaya’ has been suggested by Dikshitar (1944): 81–3.

45. See Norman (1997–8): 483. Norman also states, quite rightly, that the many elements of dhamma that are mentioned in this edict as forming what was presumably preached abroad cannot be considered Buddhist doctrine. Therefore, Ashoka cannot be seen in his edicts as propagating Buddhism among contemporary rulers.

46. Norman (1997–8): 483.

47. Line V of Erragudi Edict XIV, in Sircar (1979): 20.

Notes to Chapter 9: The Message in the Landscape